

20,000 steps a day is the ultimate fat loss cheat code

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Sep 07, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/aOc_LZSYc00 Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter recommends 20,000 daily steps over HIIT cardio for fat loss — it's easier on joints and the nervous system, preserves workout energy, controls hunger, and is accessible to everyone.

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Why Walking Beats HIIT Cardio 0:00

- Walking 20,000 steps every day is Carter's personal favorite fat-loss method
- He previously relied on HIIT cardio when younger — and found it problematic even then
 - Hard on joints even at a young age
 - Taxing on the central nervous system
- Walking avoids these downsides:
 - Can be done continuously throughout the day without excessive fatigue
 - Does not significantly drain energy needed for weight training or productive work
 - Does not spike hunger the way intense cardio does — an important advantage for staying in a calorie deficit

Tracking Your Steps 0:22

- Tracking is essential — Carter explicitly makes sure he hits the 20,000-step target daily
- Tool: the built-in **iPhone Health app**
 - Open the Health app and set a step goal of 20,000
 - No extra device or subscription required
- Outcome: hitting the target burns a significant number of calories, leading to visible fat loss

Making It Practical: Treadmill Desks and the Outdoors 0:22

- Carter's primary method: a **treadmill desk** — walking on a treadmill while working throughout the day

- Allows step accumulation without carving out separate exercise time
- Available on Amazon in the **\$500–\$1,000** price range
- Budget alternative: simply go outside
 - Costs nothing — "everyone can afford outside"
 - Makes the strategy universally accessible regardless of income